SYNTHETIC EXAMPLE POLICY -- NOT A REAL INSURER DOCUMENT
Generated for the claims-review-agent demo, adapted from the HorizonCare Silver PPO sample structure. Do not use for real coverage determinations.

Plan Name: UHC Choice Plus 2025
Effective Date: January 1, 2025
Document Version: v1.0
Applies To: In-network and out-of-network benefits unless otherwise stated.

1 Overview of Covered Benefits
This Policy provides coverage for Medically Necessary services that are not otherwise excluded. Covered Benefits include, but are not limited to:
- Physician office visits and specialist consultations
- Diagnostic imaging (e.g., ultrasound, CT, MRI)
- Outpatient and emergency surgical procedures
- Emergency services
- Prescription drugs (Formulary-based), including short-course oral antibiotics

2 Member Eligibility and Plan Status
Benefits are payable only if the member is enrolled and the Plan is active on the date of service. If the member's Plan is inactive at the time services are rendered, the claim will be denied. Denial reason: "Plan inactive at time of service."

3 Prior Authorization (Pre-Approval)
Prior Authorization is required for certain high-cost or high-risk services before they are performed.

3.1 Services Requiring Prior Authorization
The following services require Prior Authorization:
- MRI (all anatomical regions)
- CT scans (except emergency)
- Elective inpatient admissions
- Durable medical equipment (DME) exceeding $500
Claims for these services performed without approval may be denied unless retroactive authorization is granted. Emergency surgical procedures (e.g., emergency appendectomy) do not require Prior Authorization.

3.2 Documentation Required
Prior Authorization requests must include:
1. Ordering provider's clinical note
2. Relevant diagnosis code(s)
3. Prior treatment history (if applicable)
4. Expected service date and location
If documentation is missing, the request will be pended until complete information is received.

4 Medical Necessity Standard
A service is considered Medically Necessary if it is:
- Consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice;
- Clinically appropriate in type, frequency, and setting;
- Not primarily for convenience of the member or provider;
- The most cost-effective option among clinically comparable alternatives.

5 Coverage for Diagnostic Imaging
5.1 MRI Coverage
MRI is covered when all of the following conditions are met:
- A covered diagnosis is present; and
- Conservative treatment has been attempted (unless contraindicated); and

- Prior Authorization has been approved.

Examples of covered diagnoses for lumbar spine MRI include:

- M54.5 Low back pain
- M51.26 Other intervertebral disc displacement, lumbar region

5.2 Non-Covered Imaging

Diagnostic imaging is not covered when requested for screening without symptoms (unless explicitly included as preventive care), related to excluded procedures, or lacking documentation supporting Medical Necessity.

6 Exclusions

The Plan does not cover:

1. Cosmetic or reconstructive procedures not required by trauma or congenital anomaly
2. Services deemed not Medically Necessary
3. Experimental or investigational treatments
4. Services for which required Prior Authorization was not obtained
5. Duplicate claims for the same service date and provider, unless corrected and resubmitted

7 Claims Processing Rules

7.1 Duplicate Claims

A claim is considered duplicate if Member ID, Provider NPI, Date of service, CPT / procedure code, and billed amount all match. Duplicate claims will be denied with reason: "Duplicate claim submission."

7.2 Coding Consistency

Claims are routed for coding review if the diagnosis and procedure codes are clinically inconsistent based on standard coding guidelines (e.g., a screening/routine-exam diagnosis code billed alongside a major surgical procedure code). Such claims must not be approved until coding review is complete.

8 Appeals

Members and providers have the right to appeal a denial within 180 days. Appeals must include a written appeal request, the denial letter or claim reference number, and any new clinical documentation relevant to the denial reason. Appeals without new or relevant documentation may be upheld.

9 Contact Information

For questions about benefits, Prior Authorization, or claim status, contact UHC Member Support at 1-800-555-0111 or via the Member Portal.